STEP 8

Install Foundation Skills

The 13 skills that make Claude actually useful.

Time: about 15 minutes · Cost: $0 · Difficulty: beginner

Companion guide to the AI Command Center Build Guide

Corey Gray · Launch Automation

What Skills Are

Skills are little helpers inside Claude. Each one teaches Claude how to do something specific. Like making a Word doc. Or doing real research. Or transcribing a video.

You turn them on once. Claude uses them automatically from then on. You do not have to remember which skill does what. You just ask Claude to do the thing, and Claude grabs the right skill.

You are going to turn on 13 skills. None of this costs extra. It is all included with your Max plan.

Before You Start

There is one switch you have to flip first or none of the skills will work.

1. Click this link: **https://claude.ai/settings/capabilities**
2. Find the toggle that says **Code execution and file creation**
3. Click it so it turns on (blue or green)
4. If it is already on, great, move on

This switch lets Claude actually do work. Without it, the skills sit there frozen.

Open The Skills Page

Every skill lives in one place. Bookmark this link, you will come back to it.

https://claude.ai/customize/skills

When you open it, you will see a list of skills with toggle switches.

- Some skills are already in your list. Just flip the toggle.
- Some you have to add from the directory first. Click the **+** button at the top of the list. That opens a directory (kind of like an app store). Search by name. Click **Install**. Then come back and flip the toggle.

That is the whole pattern. Find skill. Toggle on. Done.

Install These 13 Skills In Order

Do them one at a time. Do not skip ahead. Check that each one toggles on before moving to the next.

Document Skills (4 of them)

1. docx

Makes Word documents.

2. xlsx

Makes Excel spreadsheets.

3. pptx

Makes PowerPoint presentations.

4. pdf

Reads, makes, and edits PDFs.

For all four: go to **https://claude.ai/customize/skills**, find each one in the list, flip the toggle on. If you cannot find one in the list, click the **+** button and search for it.

> **TIP:** These four are the most-used. Get them done first.

Foundation Skills (4 of them)

5. productivity

Your task list and Claude's memory. The skill that lets you say "ping Mike about the renewal" and Claude knows which Mike, what renewal, and where to log the task.

6. schedule

Lets Claude do things on a schedule. Like a morning briefing at 6 AM every weekday, or a Friday end-of-week summary.

7. skill-creator

Lets you build your own skills later. Do not worry about using it yet. Just turn it on.

8. consolidate-memory

Cleans up Claude's memory once a month so it stays sharp.

Same page. Find each one. Toggle on. If productivity is not in your list, click the **+** button and search for it. Click Install.

Builder Tools (5 of them)

9. mcp-builder

Helps you connect Claude to apps that are not supported out of the box. You will not use it day one. Install it anyway.

10. watch

Claude watches videos. Paste a YouTube link, Claude transcribes it, you can ask questions about it. Great for training videos and competitor research.

11. web-asset-generator

Makes favicons, app icons, and social media share images. You will need this when you build a website.

12. deep-research

The big one. Claude does real research with sources and citations. Not a Google search. Like a research paper. You will use this a lot.

13. viral-video-production

Makes Claude good at video stuff. Motion graphics, animated text, cinematic effects. If you make TikToks or Reels, install this.

Same page. Find each one. Toggle on.

Skip These For Now

You will see other skills in the directory. Do not install these unless you actually need them:

- **zoominfo** - Only useful if you have a paid ZoomInfo account
- **sanity** - Only useful if you build websites on the Sanity platform

You can always come back later and turn them on.

Test That It Worked

Open a brand new chat. Type this exactly:

> *“List the skills you have installed.”*

Claude responds with a list. Check that all 13 are there. If anything is missing, go back to **https://claude.ai/customize/skills** and check the toggle.

Then try this:

> *“Build me a quick xlsx spreadsheet that tracks my last 5 invoices. Columns: client name, amount, date.”*

If Claude makes a real Excel file you can download, the document skills are working.

Then try this:

> *“Run deep research on the top 3 competitors in my industry and their pricing models.”*

If Claude starts a long research process with sources, deep-research is working.

If all three tests pass, you are set.

Tell Your Vault What You Installed

Your vault has a file called **System/TOOLS.md** that tracks what your AI can do. Tell Claude to update it.

Open a new chat. Type:

> *“Update System/TOOLS.md with the skills I just installed and today's date.”*

Claude reads the file, adds the list, saves it. Now your vault remembers.

When Something Goes Wrong

"I do not see a Skills page."

You forgot the first step. Go to **https://claude.ai/settings/capabilities** and turn on Code execution and file creation. Refresh.

"I cannot find a skill in the list."

Click the **+** button at the top of the skills page. That opens the full directory. Search by name. Click Install. Then come back and toggle it on.

"A skill is greyed out and I cannot toggle it on."

Same fix. Code execution is not on. **https://claude.ai/settings/capabilities**. Turn it on.

"Claude is not using the skill even though I turned it on."

Be more specific in what you ask. Instead of “make me a doc” say “use the docx skill to make me a Word document about X.” Claude picks it up.

> **TIP:** Do not install skills you will not use. Every skill adds a tiny bit of weight to every chat. Stick to these 13. Add more later only when you find a real reason.

Quick Install Checklist

- Code execution turned on at https://claude.ai/settings/capabilities
- docx
- xlsx
- pptx
- pdf
- productivity
- schedule
- skill-creator
- consolidate-memory
- mcp-builder

- [ ] watch
- [ ] web-asset-generator
- [ ] deep-research
- [ ] viral-video-production
- [ ] Tested with a real prompt
- [ ] Updated System/TOOLS.md

That is Step 8 done. Move on to Step 9.

If You Get Stuck

Comment on any of my posts and I will answer publicly.

- Instagram: **@launch.automation**
- TikTok: **@launch.automation**
- YouTube: **@launch-automation-ai**
- Email: **team@launchautomation.ai**

*Want me to remote in and install these with you? Book a session at **https://launchautomation.ai/ai**. $200 for one hour. I save you a week of trial and error.*